

Your First Data Story: A Python Visualization Practice Guide

From default plots to publication-ready visuals — practice the decisions that make data speak clearly.

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#1 Build the Foundation with fig, ax

Take any CSV you have handy. Recreate a revenue trend plot using:

```
fig, ax = plt.subplots(dpi=300)
ax.yaxis.grid(True, alpha=0.3)
```

Compare with plt.plot() shortcut. Note 2 things you couldn't customize easily.

Notes:

#2 Layer Information with Seaborn's hue and size

Use a dataset with 3+ columns. Build with sns.scatterplot(hue=..., size=...). Remove hue, save. Add hue back, save. Write what info became invisible when you dropped hue — that's the encoding decision Seaborn automates.

Notes:

#3 Same Data, Three Frames

One numeric column, three subplots: fig, ax = plt.subplots(1, 3)
Line (trend) | Bar (comparison) | Scatter (relationship)
Write a 1-sentence headline per chart. Which frame matches your finding?

Notes:

#4 Remove Chart Junk

Apply: sns.set_style('whitegrid')

```
ax.spines[['top', 'right']].set_visible(False)
fontsize=12 on labels, fontweight='bold' on title
```

Save before/after at DPI=300. Count elements removed.

Notes:

#5 Match Your Plot to Your Finding

Pick the chart from #3 that most honestly represents the data.
Write 2-3 sentences: why does this chart type fit the finding?
Export at DPI=300 with bbox_inches='tight'. Would you send it to a manager?

Notes: